Superintendent's Report

School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon
Regular Board Meeting of January 24, 2005
AGENDA

1. Announcements/Celebrations
2. Report from Madison High School Student Body Co-Presidents
3. Second Reading of Policies
4. Charter Application for Victory Charter School
5. Charter Application for Portland International Charter Middle and High School
6. Superintendent's Proposal Based on Enrollment Data Analysis – Framework for Decision-Making
7. Business Agenda
8. Adjourn

INFORMAL MINUTES
Regular Board Meeting, January 24, 2005

The regular meeting of the Board of Directors came to order at 6:31 PM on the above date at the call of Co-Chair David Wynde in the Media Center of Hosford Middle School, 2303 SE 28th Place, Portland, Oregon.

There were present:

Board of Directors:
David Wynde, Co-Chair
Bobbie Regan, Co-Chair
Julia Brim-Edwards
Derry A. Jackson, Sr.
Douglas Morgan
Lolenzo Poe
Dilafruz Williams

Student Representative:
Suleima Cortez

Staff:
Vicki L. Phillips, Superintendent
Jollee Faber Patterson, General Counsel/Board Secretary
Julie Joel, Executive Assistant, Board of Education

1. ANNOUNCEMENTS/CELEBRATIONS

Co-Chair Wynde called the meeting to order and introduced Principal Melissa Sandven and Grace Gillis and Ashley Rigney, representing the Hosford Middle School Student Council.

Ashley Rigney said Hosford Middle School has a small, diverse community of 420 students. She said the school has both a Spanish and Mandarin Chinese immersion program.

Grace Gillis stated Hosford has good teachers and a strong academic program.

The Hosford Middle School choir sang "Voice from a Dream" and the Hosford Middle School Orchestra shared an arrangement of "Rustic Dance." Both groups were under the direction of instructor April Paden.

Co-Chair Wynde said it was a wonderful start to the meeting and noted Student Representative Cortez would leave the meeting early due to finals week and Director Jackson also had to leave early.

Congratulations to PPS Transportation Department

Director Brim-Edwards congratulated Bryan Winchester, Director of Student Transportation Services, and his staff on being named by School Bus Fleet magazine in their December issue as one of the top 100 school district fleets in the United States. She noted that with over 11,000 students transported on a daily basis and nearly 250 bus routes, Student Transportation made this annual listing along with larger schools district such as New York City. Director Brim-Edwards said the Board deeply appreciates the efforts of the employees in this department who get our students to and from school safely each and every day.

National School Counseling Week

Director Poe said National School Counseling Week is celebrated February 7-11 this year. The theme is "School Counselors Point You in the Right Direction." He said the District's school counselors work to address the personal and social growth and career development of Portland Public Schools' students. On behalf of the Board, Director Poe thanked all of the District's counselors for their hard work, dedication and the difference they make in the lives of the children of PPS every day. It was noted that Board members would visit at least two to three schools each during National School Counseling Week in order to meet and personally thank school counselors.

Pam Wilson, Assistant Director of Student Services, and Elizabeth Burns, Counselor at George Middle School, handed out pencils to Board members commemorating school counselors.

Ms. Wilson stated there are over 100 counselors in Portland Public Schools K-12 programs. She said they are proud of the work they do and are looking forward to new directions in school counseling as they work with others on school counseling reform. She thanked members of the Board for their support.

Celebrate! Portland Public Schools

Director Morgan said a majority of the Board witnessed one of the more remarkable events that the School District celebrates – Celebrate! Portland Public Schools. The event happened on January 18th and was an opportunity for parents to see all the educational choice opportunities offered by Portland Public Schools. He noted over 10,000 attended the event, which was held at the Memorial Coliseum, and 1,100 students participated in entertainment activities. Director Morgan said teachers and parents advised families who were shopping for schools. On behalf of the Board, he thanked all those parents and teachers who helped out that night. He especially thanked Ann Nice, President of the Portland Association of Teachers, who helped to make it a special event. He further thanked principals, central leadership staff and event sponsors. Director Morgan said a more formal thank you would take place at the February 14, 2005 School Board meeting.

Stockamp and Associates' Donation to Humboldt Elementary

Co-Chair Wynde introduced Brenda Gustafson, PPS Communications, and Jamila Williams, Principal of Humboldt Middle School.

Ms. Williams stated on January 14th Humboldt dedicated a new playground, and the equipment was donated by Stockamp and Associates. She added Stockamp sent employees over on a rainy Saturday to put the equipment together. She thanked Lucas Garcia, Sheryl James and Nancy Clark – all parents from Humboldt -- for their help in making the project a reality. She further thanked the representatives from Stockamp who were in attendance.

The Superintendent and Board Co-Chairs presented all with certificates and tokens of appreciation.

Overview of Principal for a Day Activities

Co-Chair Wynde said Principal for a Day will be held on February 2nd.

Jan Wierima, PPS Partnership Coordinator, introduced Kurt Henniger, Vice President and Manager of Comcast, who also serves as co-chair of the event along with Al Jubitz. She said Comcast is a major sponsor of Principal for a Day. She also thanked the Portland Schools Foundation for bringing this event to Portland Public Schools. Ms. Wierima noted this is the fifth year for Principal for a Day, and noted the importance of having business and civic leaders visit our schools.

Kurt Henniger said Comcast was proud to be a part of Principal for a Day. He said planning was going well and they hoped to attract 100 business leaders to the 110 school sites. He noted it is a way for businesses to become involved in schools and also to see best practices at work. He said Comcast is a sponsor, along with the Business Journal and Al Jubitz.

Co-Chair Wynde thanked Mr. Henniger for Comcast's support of this very special event.

Thank You to Dr. Patricia Pickles

Director Jackson said it was an honor to recognize Dr. Patricia Pickles, Chief Academic Officer for Portland Public Schools. He said earlier in the evening a reception was held honoring Dr. Pickles for her service to the students of this School District. She served as the District's Chief Academic Officer until her announcement that she is the new Superintendent of the Pflugerville (Texas) Independent School District. Director Jackson said in 2000 the PPS community came together to draft a five-year Strategic Plan. The following year Superintendent Scherzinger recruited Dr. Pickles and gave her the task of crafting the Action Plan for the Strategic Plan. Director Jackson said the work Dr. Pickles presented in the Action Plan will continue to be the backbone of the School District. He said he is aware that Dr. Pickles is pleased to return to Texas to be closer to her family, and she is also very excited to the new Superintendent of this fast-growing district with 17,600 students. On behalf of the Board of Education, Director Jackson wished Dr. Pickles the very best in her new assignment.

The Board Co-Chairs presented Dr. Pickles with an engraved pen set.

Director Poe thanked Dr. Pickles for her leadership, intellect, charm, grace and beauty and for standing fast and firm in her commitment to all children

achieving. He said she will always be loved by a large group of people in Portland Public Schools.

Legislative Update

Co-Chair Regan said Portland Public Schools is in the process of solidifying issues, such as adequate state funding for schools. She said PPS would be a visible and vocal voice in Salem during this session. She said the Board would be approving a contract on the evening's Business Agenda for the consulting services of Justin Martin with Perseverance Strategies (Resolution #3193). She said he has the skills and experience necessary to provide government relations and lobbying services for Portland Public Schools.

Co-Chair Regan announced on February 17th the Oregon PTA will hold a Legislative summit and Founders Day Celebration, and she noted Oregon PTA is celebrating a 100th anniversary. It will be from 9 AM to 3 PM and activities will include presentations from Citizens for Oregon's Future, Chalkboard Project, and participants will visit legislators. If you need more information, you can call 503-234-3928 or visit their website at http://www.oregonpta.org.

Co-Chair Regan said that February 21st (Presidents' Day) there will be a "Responsible School Funding Rally" at the State Capitol (on the capitol steps) at noon. She said some sponsors of the event include Stand for Children, Oregon Bus Project, Oregon Business Association, Oregon PTA and Oregon School Funding Now. Busses will be leaving from various sites in Portland, and legislative visits (and training) are scheduled from 10 AM to 3 PM. Co-Chair Regan encouraged students, parents, staff, community advocates and Board members to attend this rally and tell their legislators "no more cuts to the classrooms!" For more details you may call Shannon at Stand for Children at 503-235-2305, extension 103 or email her at Shannon@stand.org. You can visit the Stand for Children website at http://www.stand.org.

In closing, Co-Chair Regan said there is more at stake in this legislative session for Portland's students than ever before.

Change in Committee Assignments

Co-Chair Wynde announced the new Board committee assignments. (A copy of the new assignments is attached to these minutes or may be viewed on the PPS website at http://www.pps.k12.or.us/.docs/pg/5868).

Replays

Student Representative Cortez announced the replays of the January 10, 2005 meeting can be viewed on Channel 28 on:

Wednesday, Jan. 12, 2005	9:30 PM
Friday, Jan. 14, 2005	10:00 AM and 8:30 PM
Saturday, Jan. 15, 2005	7:30 PM
Sunday, Jan. 16, 2005	4:00 PM
Monday, Jan. 17, 2005	8:00 AM

National School Board Recognition Month

Superintendent Phillips announced that January is National School Board Recognition Month. She said the Portland School Board is a dedicated and courageous group of volunteers who spend countless hours on behalf of students, staff and families. As a Superintendent, she said she could not ask for a more committed Board. She thanked the Board for all of their work and handed out tokens of appreciation to each Board member and the Student Representative and certificates (from the Oregon School Boards Association).

2. **REPORT FROM MADISON HIGH SCHOOL STUDENT BODY CO-PRESIDENTS**

Student Representative Suleima Cortez introduced the student body co-presidents from Madison High School – Kristina Stone and Anesh Nath.

Ms. Stone handed out some information about Madison High School to the Board. She said Madison High School is one of the most diverse schools in Oregon. She noted that Madison has a Gay/Straight Alliance and said the club was not just for gay, lesbian and bisexual students but a club that helps make all students feel safe in their school environment. She also shared a copy of the school newspaper, "The Constitution."

Mr. Nath discussed various programs at Madison including the Speech and Communications Academy and the Academy of Sciences and Natural Resources. He said Madison High School's Speech Team placed second in state competition. He emphasized that Madison is a great school.

Director Regan thanked the students and noted that Madison High School Principal Pat Thompson was in the audience.

Ms. Cortez urged interested students to come to SuperSAC (Superintendent's Student Advisory Council) meetings every Thursday at 6:30 AM in the Tubman Middle School library.

3. **SECOND READING OF POLICIES**

Co-Chair Wynde said there were two policies before the Board for a Second Reading. He said the third policy, 5.60.010-P Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment, which was scheduled for a Second Reading warranted another First Reading due to changes within the policy.

First Reading: Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment, 5.60.010-P

Co-Chair Wynde read the First Reading information for 5.60.010-P, Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment. The policy establishes standards for non-licensed administrative contracts. The proposed policy may be viewed on the PPS website at http://www.pps.k12.or.us/.docs/pg/6492. The policy contact is Vicki L. Phillips, P.O. Box 3107, Portland, OR 97208-3107; telephone 503-916-3200; email vphillips@pps.k12.or.us. The last date for public comment is February 24, 2005.

Director Brim-Edwards stated several amendments to the draft policy (5.60.010-P) would be proposed and posted on the website.

Co-Chair Wynde said the Board would consider adoption of Policy 5.60.010-P at the February 28, 2005 School Board meeting.

Second Reading: Reimbursement of Expenses – Board of Directors, 1.40.080-P

Director Brim-Edwards said this policy came about as the result of an audit recommendation wherein there was a need to have a formal policy regarding Board expenses. She thanked Heidi Franklin for her work on this policy, and said the policy provides guidelines for Board members. She noted there has always been a Board Office budget, just no policy in place to govern that budget. She thanked Director Poe for his input in the process. The policy is recommended for a Second Reading and adoption by the Community and Staff Relations Committee.

The Board unanimously approved adoption of Policy 1.40.080-P per Resolution 3196 by a vote of 7-0, Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial.

Second Reading: Student Enrollment and Transfers, 4.10.051-P

Director Williams, Chair of the Education Options and Professional Development Committee, stated there were no changes to the draft policy after the First Reading. She said her committee recommended the policy for a Second Reading and adoption.

The Board unanimously approved adoption of Policy 4.10.051-P per Resolution 3197 by a vote of 7-0, Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial.

4. CHARTER APPLICATION FOR VICTORY CHARTER SCHOOL

Director Williams thanked staff for their work on the charter applications, and specifically thanked Susan Kosmala, PPS Charter Schools Manager, for her diligence and meticulous work on the charter applications. She further thanked Dr. Maxine Kilcrease and all PPS staff involved in reviewing the applications. She noted to date, the Portland School Board has approved eight charters and denied three charters. She referenced her memorandum which outlines the reasons why the Education Options and Professional Development Committee is recommending denial of the Victory Charter School application (a copy of the memorandum is attached to these minutes or may be obtained from the Board Support Office).

Director Williams stated the committee's reasons for denying the charter application for Victory Charter School as overall the proposal did not meet the minimum requirements in the areas of Educational Program, Support for Learning, and Financial, Business and Organizational Plan.

Applicant's Comments

Mr. Cottrell White, Principal of Victory Charter School and representing the applicant, stated his surprise that the committee voted unanimously to recommend denial of the application to the full Board. He said Victory would not give up hope, and they would apply again to the state to continue their charter.

Citizen Comment

Viesa Loving – Ms. Loving, grandparent of a Victory student, said Portland Public Schools has not lived up to promises it made over 30 years ago. She said Victory would have been a positive start in fulfilling that promise, and she was angry because children have been let down for so long.

Board Discussion

Director Jackson said he would not support the resolution, which denies the charter application to Victory. He said he felt that "Victory is a victory for Northeast Portland." He urged Victory to not give up in their pursuit of a charter with Portland Public Schools. He also said Mr. White is a great man. He said he would help and support Victory in their efforts.

Director Brim-Edwards asked if there were conversations with Oregon Department of Education (ODE) regarding the likelihood that the state would renew Victory's charter for a third year, and she asked how the state viewed the applicant.

Ms. Kosmala responded she had conversations with Rex Crouse from ODE, and he indicated the State Board would probably look at the Victory Charter renewal in April. She said the state was currently waiting for the results of an independent evaluation of Victory. Ms. Kosmala noted that the state required that Victory apply for a charter with Portland Public Schools.

Director Morgan said it was important for him to see sustainability, and he needed to see sufficient evidence to show that the school is sustainable. He said he would vote in favor of the resolution which would deny the charter application.

Director Regan said she was very impressed with the passion of the parents, community members, principal and other organizers at the charter hearing for Victory. She said it was with a heavy heart that she decided not to support the charter application. She expressed concern about the drop in enrollment. Director Regan said it was her hope that the state would support the Victory charter for a third year and they could then come back to Portland Public Schools next year with better statistics and data to support their application.

Director Poe stated he would join Director Jackson and would vote in favor of the applicant. He said if the Board applied the same standards to the District, most schools would be closed. He emphasized that at some

point, the passion and desire to educate children merits a chance … "the opportunity for individuals to try to do something that even in our best efforts we have not been able to do." Director Poe noted he sees achievement data for PPS and it fluctuates from school to school, and he questioned if the same measurements were being applied to this charter applicant. Director Poe stated Mr. White had helped to get him to where he is today. He asked if an analysis was done to see how Victory's achievement fluctuation and declining enrollment compared to other schools in the Northeast area of Portland.

Ms. Kosmala responded that staff looked at enrollment at Ockley Green Middle School, Tubman Middle School and Whitaker Middle School and when looking at enrollment in aggregate from October 2003 to October 2004, the retention rate was approximately 82% and Victory's was approximately 60%.

Director Poe asked about academic achievement.

Ms. Kosmala said staff looked at the results of the California Achievement Tests, which were used by Victory.

Director Brim-Edwards stated not having the state evaluate the applicant's charter until the end of the school year made it difficult for the Portland School Board to make a decision.

Director Poe asked for more information regarding the issue of financial instability.

Ms. Kosmala responded that the salary was listed as $35,000 for instructional (licensed) staff and $12,000 for instructional aides, which she said was at the very lowest end of the scale for PPS. She said staff questioned whether Victory could be competitive in the hiring process with those salary offerings. She further stated with Victory's structured curriculum, they were concerned that Victory would not have the qualified staff to receive training and would then be in a perpetual training process for staff.

The Board voted to approve Resolution 3198, which denied the charter application for Victory Charter School, by a vote of 5-2 (Directors Jackson and Poe voting no; Student Representative Cortez voting no, unofficial).

5. **CHARTER APPLICATION FOR PORTLAND INTERNATIONAL CHARTER MIDDLE AND HIGH SCHOOL**

Director Williams referenced her memorandum which outlines the reasons why the Education Options and Professional Development Committee is recommending denial of the charter application for Portland International Charter Middle and High School (a copy of the memorandum is attached to these minutes or may be obtained from the Board Support Office).

Director Williams said the applicant submitted a revised application at the charter hearing on January 11th, but at that time it was considered an additional document and not a formal new application. She outlined the committee's reasons for recommending denial of the application to the full Board as: the proposal did not meet the minimum requirements in the areas of Educational Program, Support for Learning, and Financial, Business and Organizational Plan.

Applicant's Comments

Jeffrey Boly, representing the applicant, referenced his Memorandum to the Board of Education dated January 24, 2005 (a copy of this document is available in the Board Support Office) and said the applicant was trying to accomplish an ideal school with state-of-the-art best practices. Mr. Boly said the applicant tried to enlist the involvement of good educational professionals, and noted the initial lead administrator for the proposed charter school would be a retired principal from Gresham High School who during his tenure there began the International Baccalaureate program at that school. Mr. Boly said the person they proposed to lead fundraising efforts, Mr. Bob Scanlon, is extremely good at fundraising and has proven results. He noted there is a disconnect between state standards and PPS standards. He said the state gave the charter applicant a $350,000 start-up grant and rated their application a 90.7. Mr. Boly said his biggest concern is that, as he interprets the law, it is not enough to tell a charter applicant that there are problems with the application, but the state requires the district to tell the applicant what they need to do in the form of guidance. In closing, Mr. Boly said the applicant hopes to work with PPS in a collaborative, cooperative way and find out what more is needed to accomplish goals that all agree are optimal.

Board Discussion

Director Poe said he was struck by Mr. Boly's comment regarding state versus PPS standards.

Ms. Kosmala responded that state law on charter schools lists about 19-20 criteria that must be included in the application, but allows school districts to develop their own criteria and standards.

Director Poe said the broader community needs an explanation as to why the state could grant a charter and give a high rating and then the charter applicant goes to PPS and they fail and are not given a charter. He also questioned the issue in the denial of "anti-competition" and asked about the impact on an immersion program.

Ms. Kosmala responded that it was a concern to locate an IB program within blocks of Lincoln High School, which also has an IB program.

Director Brim-Edwards said she served on the Board when PPS started the International School at Hosford Middle School, and she said at that time there were issues of starting an immersion program at mid-level and then having a critical mass that could support the program. She said if programs are divided at the middle school level, there might not be critical mass to support the program unless the School District provided additional FTE.

Co-Chair Wynde noted the state allowed one criteria for denial of an application to be the impact on existing programs/schools.

Co-Chair Regan said last year there were lengthy discussions in the Community and Staff Relations Committee relative to having very few options identified in North and Northeast Portland. She said having the proposed charter school located in Southwest Portland did not rate favorably with the committee.

Director Poe said he has had problems with the District's chartering process since he began his tenure on the School Board. For him, he emphasized it was a question of fairness and can the proposed charter help groups of students that PPS cannot reach. Director Poe said he would vote in favor of the applicant's charter application.

Maxine Kilcrease, Assistant to the Superintendent, referenced the discrepancy between the state and Portland Public Schools (as questioned earlier by Director Poe). She stated it was worth noting that what the Oregon Department of Education approved regarding the charter applicant was a planning grant for $25,000. She said the $350,000 figure would be the amount awarded to the applicant should PPS grant the charter.

Ms. Kosmala said in December 2004, PPS sent an 11-page report to the applicant going over criteria by criteria and noting strengths and weaknesses within the application. She said concerns were indicated in specific areas of the application.

Director Morgan asked how many times the applicant asked for guidance and what guidance was then given to the applicant.

Ms. Kosmala responded she became aware of the potential to receive an application from the applicant in mid-October 2004 when a call was received from the Beaverton School District. She said she asked the Beaverton School District to have the applicant get in touch with her, and she sent them the PPS charter application packet the same day. Ms. Kosmala indicated the application was sent to the District on November 1, but it was incomplete. She said the resubmitted application was found to be complete, and it was reviewed by ten staff members. Ms. Kosmala said the staff review was sent to the applicant on December 22 so they would have a chance to see what the staff concerns were prior to the hearing. She said she met with the applicant on January 5, 2005 and they discussed the staff review and how to prepare for the hearing on January 11th.

In response to another question from Director Morgan, Ms. Kosmala stated that at the hearing on January 11th the applicant had one hour to present their case. She said she spoke with them prior to the hearing about some concerns and suggested those be the focus of their presentation at the hearing. She said per their request, she also gave them a copy of the Garden Laboratory 's charter as well as other documents they requested. She indicated the applicant forwarded additional documents and the Board also requested some documents.

Director Regan asked about the state's rating of the applicant.

Ms. Kosmala responded the rating was based on the grant application and had different questions than the charter application.

Some discussion ensued regarding the concern with the extensive use of Portland State University throughout the initial application and concerns connected with having to raise $1 million.

Director Brim-Edwards asked about a charter being sponsored by multiple school districts.

Dr. Kilcrease said PPS had not been approached by any other school district regarding this charter application.

Jollee Patterson, General Counsel/Board Secretary, noted the Board previously approved resolutions for several charters wherein it was designated the charter school must be located in a particular quadrant of the district, and she indicated the state did not have a problem with that directive.

Director Morgan stated he was struck by the extent to which the application is a "trust me" application. He said he needs confidence in a plan, not necessarily the people. He referenced the letter received from the applicant which suggested the Board was opposed to choice by denying their charter application, and he said the Board approved eight of eleven charter applications they received. He indicated he would not vote to approve the application, as the applicant had not done due diligence.

Director Brim-Edwards said future charter applicants should note that as a Board member she would look more favorably on an application that wanted to be located in North Portland. She referenced the letter received from the applicant which she viewed as an adversarial attack and said the Board has a fiduciary responsibility to the citizens that charter schools will be financially stable. She added she was not hostile to charter schools, but rather PPS has a very rigorous screening process. She indicated she would support denying the applicant's charter proposal, but noted there were some merits to the application.

Director Poe stated approving eight out of eleven applications sounds good, but there were other charter applications that did not get to the formal process. He said PPS needed to address the systemic process involving charter applications, and he added he did not feel equity was being applied. Director Poe stressed he was not criticizing any individual, but the process, and he said it must be more up front and transparent.

Co-Chair Wynde stated the Education Options and Professional Development Committee took the issue of equity very seriously. He said the decision to deny the charter application was not solely because the committee did not think it was appropriate to locate the charter adjacent to Lincoln. He noted the six areas of concern outlined in the resolution which recommends denial of the application. Co-Chair Wynde stated committee members were not satisfied that the proposal would be able to address the needs of students who were the most disadvantaged in the School District.

The Board voted to approve Resolution 3199, which denied the charter application for Portland International Charter Middle and High School, by a

vote of 5-1 (Director Poe voting no; Director Jackson absent from voting; Student Representative Cortez absent from voting).

6. **SUPERINTENDENT'S PROPOSAL BASED ON ENROLLMENT DATA ANALYSIS – FRAMEWORK FOR DECISION-MAKING**

Superintendent Phillips referenced the school profiles of all PPS elementary schools as contained in the Board Book. She said discussions will continue over the next few weeks with District staff, and her goal is to bring proposals, not recommendations, to the February 14th School Board meeting. The Superintendent indicated that there would be more conversations with the community and data would continue to be made available. She said this year the framework for decision-making is being accomplished, so next year the entire process can start earlier in the school year, most likely in October, and the Board would vote on recommendations in January. (A copy of Superintendent Phillips' Power Point presentation is attached to these minutes or may be obtained from the Board Support Office.)

Superintendent Phillips laid out the three stages in the framework for decision making as: 1) initial data analysis and implications, 2) building level and 3) educational analysis, and implementation strategy. She said possible decisions could be made regarding: boundary alignments; program initiation; expansion, or closure; school initiation or closure; and/or restructuring the delivery of effective instruction. Superintendent Phillips discussed what would happen in each of the three stages of the framework. In closing, she discussed the timeline which will culminate with her recommendations and Board approval, tentatively scheduled for the February 28, 2005 School Board meeting.

Board Discussion

Director Williams asked if staff were looking at enrollment trends/drop-out rates for ELL (English Language Learners) and TAG (Talented and Gifted) students.

Superintendent Phillips replied staff would look at that when they look at the middle and high school data. She said they currently were only looking at the elementary level.

Director Poe asked the Superintendent if any "surprises" were noted as the information was put together.

Superintendent Phillips responded that the potential capture rate in some schools was a surprise. She said the first goal is for every neighborhood school to have options and choices and then see if that school then captures more students due to a really good neighborhood program.

Co-Chair Regan asked the Superintendent to explain the variance in the budget-per-student from school to school.

The Superintendent responded that the per-student budget includes Title I money and another problem was ADM (Average Daily Membership) can lag behind and inflate numbers.

Director Morgan said terrific work was done in a very short amount of time and the Superintendent needed to be congratulated, along with the leadership team. He said it is difficult to make budget decisions without that kind of analysis, and even if tough decisions must be made, the Board will have the best data in terms of the central mission of Portland Public Schools.

Director Brim-Edwards noted the short timeframe between the February 14th and the February 28th Board meetings and said if there were school closures, that would not allow enough time for community discussion.

Superintendent Phillips responded that it was a very aggressive timeline this year, as they were working for a mid-March budget proposal. She emphasized that she wants and welcomes extensive community discussion.

Director Brim-Edwards noted 30 schools could be closed based on different criteria. She asked what combination of criteria would be used, and what were the key criteria.

Superintendent Phillips responded it would be a combination of factors that would drive the decision for closures, and she stated the one thing that would be important was getting a better service delivery model for kids with the intention of increased student achievement.

Co-Chair Wynde noted that the enrollment data analysis was one management process that was being developed, but not the only one. He said reviewing student achievement data was another process that the Board would expect the instructional team to be involved in and that process could yield recommendations for program changes independent of the enrollment data.

Superintendent Phillips agreed and said a good example of that was the cost effectiveness of moving to full-day kindergarten.

Co-Chair Regan asked if different delivery models such as K-6 or K-8 were a possibility.

Superintendent Phillips said they should not close off any options, and national test data shows that the K-8 model outperforms other delivery models.

Citizen Comment

Victoria Guillabeau – Ms. Guillabeau, Region 2 Representative for the Oregon PTA, expressed appreciation on behalf of the Oregon PTA to the Superintendent and leadership team for the excellent job in demystifying a process that previously had been extremely frustrating. She said there were two things she would like to see addressed: 1) the number of volunteers a building has is representative of the health of the building's culture; and 2) in looking at the numbers for the elementary schools, she is concerned that Portland Schools Foundation money was not being factored into the budget per student.

7. **BUSINESS AGENDA**

Director Williams announced a potential conflict of interest on Resolution 3194.

Director Brim-Edwards noted the agenda item (Resolution 3192) which authorizes funding for the Whitaker-Adams site planning. She asked Director Morgan, Chair of Finance, Audit and Operations, if his committee would look at the possibility of what would happen to that site if the bond is not renewed. She said the committee should look at that issue soon, so if there is no bond, they will have a plan for the students currently at Whitaker Lakeside.

Co-Chair Wynde noted the resolution authorizes possible funding but does not commit to funding.

8. **ADJOURN**

Co-Chair Wynde announced the next regular meeting of the Board of Education will be held at on Monday, February 14, 2005, at 6:30 PM at the Blanchard Education Service Center.

The regular meeting of the Board of Education for January 24, 2005 adjourned at 9:39 PM at the call of Co-Chair David Wynde.

Submitted by:

_____
Julie Joel, Executive Assistant
PPS Board of Education